Sonde

Accessibility Health Check

https://polkcountyiowa.gov

983

Excellent

April 11, 2026
Provided free by Sonde

https://daylight.sonde.life/section508/polkcountyiowa-gov/

1 pages | **7** findings | **0** critical | **3** high | **4** medium | **0** low | **7.0** avg/page | **7** elements | **4** with findings | **42.9%** ECR | **21.7s** total | **21.7s** per page

Top Findings

HIGH <html> element must have a lang attribute: Fix any of the following: The <html> element does not have a lang attribute WCAG 3.1.1

Page: / WCAG 3.1.1

Element:

```
<html><head>
<title>Access Denied</title>
</head><body>
<h1>Access Denied</h1>

You don't have permission to access "http://polkcountyiowa.gov/" on this server.<p>
Reference #18.8c1c1602.1775901367.3...
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure every HTML document has a lang attribute. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/language-of-page Add a lang attribute to the <html> element with a valid BCP 47 language tag. Example: <html lang="en">.

HIGH Page has no detectable navigation mechanisms (no <nav>, search, sitemap link, breadcrumbs, or table of contents). Users need multiple ways to locate content. WCAG 2.4.5

Page: / WCAG 2.4.5

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add at least two of: site navigation (<nav>), search functionality (input[type="search"] or role="search"), a sitemap link, breadcrumb navigation, or a table of contents.

HIGH Missing X-Content-Type-Options header

Page: /

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff Add X-Frame-Options: DENY or SAMEORIGIN Add a Content-Security-Policy header with appropriate directives Add Referrer-Policy: strict-origin-when-cross-origin or no-referrer

MEDIUM

All page content should be contained by landmarks: Fix any of the following: Some page content is not contained by landmarks

Page: /

Element:

```
<h1>Access Denied</h1>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure all page content is contained by landmarks. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/

MEDIUM

All page content should be contained by landmarks: Fix any of the following: Some page content is not contained by landmarks

Page: /

Element:

```
<p>https://errors.edgesuite.net/18.8c1c1602.1775901367.3ec1f92c</p>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure all page content is contained by landmarks. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/

MEDIUM

All page content should be contained by landmarks: Fix any of the following: Some page content is not contained by landmarks

Page: /

Element:

```
<p>
Reference #18.8c1c1602.1775901367.3ec1f92c
</p>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure all page content is contained by landmarks. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/

MEDIUM

Document should have one main landmark: Fix all of the following: Document does not have a main landmark

Page: /

Element:

```
<html><head>
<title>Access Denied</title>
</head><body>
<h1>Access Denied</h1>

You don't have permission to access "http://polkcountyiowa.gov/" on this server.<p>
Reference #18.8c1c1602.1775901367.3...
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure the document has a main landmark. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/

Methodology

The Sonde Score is a universal 0–1000 compliance index — think of it like a credit score for accessibility. Each finding is weighted by its impact on human access: a keyboard trap (critical) counts far more than a best-practice suggestion (low). The raw penalty is normalized per page so scores are comparable across sites of any size. A harmonic curve ensures every site gets a meaningful score — no zeros, no false perfection.

```
Score = round(1000 × S / (S + P/N))
```

where S = sensitivity (750), P = Σ(weight × count), N = pages scanned

TIER	WEIGHT	EXAMPLES
Critical	10	Keyboard traps, missing page language
High	3	Missing alt text, insufficient contrast
Medium	1	Heading hierarchy, unclear link purpose
Low	0.25	Best-practice suggestions

The Sonde Score is a living standard (v0.1). We're building it in the open because accessibility is too important for closed-door decisions. Your expertise makes it better.

Enter Mission Control

Review raw findings data, track changes between scans, and contribute to Sonde's open methodology.

View Findings Data | Track Changes | Nominate a Site | Report a Scanning Issue

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This report is a health check, not a verdict. Every website has room to improve.

Disclaimer: This report presents the results of automated accessibility analysis and is provided free of charge, as-is, without warranty of any kind. Findings are generated by software, not by human accessibility experts, and may contain errors or omissions. Automated testing can detect approximately 30–40% of accessibility issues; manual expert evaluation is recommended for complete conformance assessment. Scores reflect algorithmic analysis under a published methodology open to public review—they are not legal determinations of compliance. Results reflect the state of the website at the time of scanning and may change as the site is updated. Nothing in this report constitutes legal advice. Sonde assumes no liability for decisions made based on these results.

Leaderboard Methodology

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